

REMOTE WORK STILL IN DEMAND

In July 2021, Naukri.com introduced the option of letting recruiters tag their remote job postings as 'Permanent Remote' or 'Temporary Work from Home during Covid'.

→	Between July 2021 and Jan 2022, over 93,000 permanent and temporary remote jobs were listed from Amazon, Tech Mahindra, TCS, Deloitte, Oracle, PwC and other firms
→	22 per cent of them were for permanent remote roles only
→	Over 3.2 million job searches for permanent and temporary remote jobs were made using these filters
→	About 57 per cent searches were for permanent remote jobs during the same time, with the highest search count of over 0.35 million in December 2021 alone

SOURCE: NAUKRI.COM



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Microsoft, HSBC and Goldman Sachs will have to take a call and say, 'This is what my working model is going to be', and a lot of the industry is going to follow that." Meanwhile, companies will have to work out several finer details. General Manager & Head (India & SAARC) of Zoom Video Communications, Sameer Raje, says the movement of talent to smaller cities necessitates taking infrastructure load off the metros and strengthening capacities in non-metros. "Connectivity can be a challenge and the internet fluctuates in smaller towns." Referring to a proposed IT ministry-Nasscom project to develop 100 smaller cities from where employees can work remotely, he says more such initiatives will be needed.

PRADEEP SAYS EMPLOYMENT contracts are also being tweaked to clarify when employees are required to work from office and when they can work from home, to include force majeure clauses as well as to specify the appropriate conduct in remote and flexible working. Linking pay to location is another topic of discussion among employers. But Deloitte India's Partner (Consulting) Anandurup Ghose doubts companies will implement it. "But they

will have to figure out how performance management and cultural issues can be addressed for a hybrid workforce," he says.

The general consensus is that the next four to six months will be all about experimenting and discovering what works for a specific organisation and its employees, with 2023 ushering in a stable and static new normal of working, provided there are no further serious disruptions. The senior HR professional who chose to stay anonymous adds that employees also need six to seven months to unwind after two stressful years, before they can return to normalcy. Careernet's Das likens the process to trying to build a bridge over a moving road. "That whole discovery and seeing the future road ahead is the bigger problem today. Once you see the road ahead, putting up the guardrails to that era is not a problem."

With the risks of employees losing their advantage when the job market cools off at some point as well as employers driving away good talent with their unhelpful policies, the time is ripe for both sides to get to the negotiation table for a heart-to-heart on how they envision hybrid work. **BT**

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